MONTHLY UPDATE

Zimbabwe: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE
Strategies, plans and policies · Legislation and regulation · Data protection · Regional collaboration · Public debate and participation in policymaking

ICT INFRASTRUCTURE
Connectivity · Energy · Cybersecurity

DPI
Data Exchange · Digital Payments and Fintech · Registries · Sectoral management information systems · Other GovTech and e-Gov

DIGITALISATION
Rural digital data capture

TECHNOLOGY
AI · Innovation ecosystem

CAPACITY
Training and skills · Research institutions

INCLUSION
Access to services

GEOPOLITICS
US / hyperscaler activities

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

POSTAL AND COURIER SERVICES POLICY

- **Mavetera sets 2030 deadline for Smart Post Offices** — Spiked Media, 19 September 2026

  250-plus post offices to become smart service centres by 2030; AI parcel tracking, drones, USO funding fix.

- **Zimbabwe sets out plan to modernise postal and courier services for digital economy** — TechReviewAfrica, 20 September 2026

  Stabilise, commercialise, capitalise; postal amendment bill before Parliament; e-commerce bill in drafting.

REGULATOR'S COMMERCIAL ARRANGEMENTS UNIT

- **ICT Minister Mavetera directs Potraz to establish unit to police operator deals** — The Herald (Zimbabwe), 6 October 2026

Zimbabwe's ICT minister asked the telecommunications regulator to consider a dedicated unit to oversee operators' commercial arrangements, mediate disputes and enforce active infrastructure sharing. She also wants the Universal Service Fund to reach every marginalised ward and the regulator's sharing and tower-relocation directives evaluated in 2027.

POSTAL AND COURIER SECTOR TRANSFORMATION IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

- **Government gives postal sector 90 days for transformation plan** — The Herald, 12 October 2026

  Zimbabwe's ICT minister gave her ministry, the regulator and the postal operator 90 days to produce a costed plan for the postal and courier sector to 2030, with quarterly reporting. She also directed operators to comply with the Cyber and Data Protection Act and required pilots of artificial intelligence and drones to carry a named lead, a timetable and measurable benefits.

Legislation and regulation

STATUTORY INSTRUMENT ON E-HAILING SERVICES

- **InDrive, Bolt providing affordable, dignified services – says government, as e-hailing services get five-month reprieve** — NewZimbabwe, 9 September 2026

  Cabinet gives e-hailing platforms a five-month moratorium pending a self-regulating framework and a tax arrangement.

E-COMMERCE AND E-TRANSACTIONS BILL

- **Mavetera sets 2030 deadline for Smart Post Offices** — Spiked Media, 19 September 2026

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **Zimbabwe sets out plan to modernise postal and courier services for digital economy** — TechReviewAfrica, 20 September 2026

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

Data protection

NATIONAL CHILD ONLINE PROTECTION POLICY 2026-2030

- **Zim rolling out gateways, teacher and parents training in line with the Child Online Protection Policy** — New Ziana, 10 September 2026

  Content gateways on public free Wi-Fi and in schools; Mavetera to the National Assembly, 2026-09-09.

ADMINISTRATIVE SANCTIONS UNDER THE DATA PROTECTION ACT

- **The inaugural Africa Data Protection Day** — Scientific and Industrial Research and Development Centre (SIRDC), Zimbabwe, 23 September 2026

  Day marked at POTRAZ consultative workshop on CDPA guidelines and SI 155 of 2024 amendments on administrative fines.

Regional collaboration

NETWORK OF AFRICAN DATA PROTECTION AUTHORITIES MEMBERSHIP

- **POTRAZ Joins Continental Partners to Commemorate Inaugural Africa Data Protection Day** — TechnoMag, 22 September 2026

> Zimbabwe's regulator POTRAZ, which acts as the country's data protection authority, marked the first Africa Data Protection Day on 21 September. The day commemorates the 2016 founding of the Network of African Data Protection Authorities, which now has 34 members and in which POTRAZ is second vice-president.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

> PARLIAMENTARY COMMITTEE OF THE FUTURE

- **DR. B. Chirume Appointed To Parliamentary Committee Of The Future As Zimbabwe Eyes 30-Year Digital Roadmap** — TechnoMag, 4 September 2026

  ICT permanent secretary Chirume joins the body planning Zimbabwe's Vision 2056 digital roadmap.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

> RETIREMENT OF THE 3G NETWORK

- **Econet says to phase out 3G by end of 2027** — NewsDay, 10 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's largest operator will shut down its 3G network by the end of December 2027, its chief executive said, retiring 3G before 2G because 2G remains widely used in rural areas by subscribers with basic feature phones. The operator is accelerating investment in 4G and 5G.

> ECONET INFRACO

- **Econet InfraCo - Unaudited Abridged Interim Financial Statements for the Half Year Ended 31 August 2026** — Econet Infrastructure Company Limited, 1 October 2026

  Issuer's own statements: US$13.7m half-year profit, no interim dividend; not comparable after USD switch 1 Mar 2026.

- **Econet InfraCo reports solid maiden half-year results after VFEX listing** — The Herald (Zimbabwe), 4 October 2026

  Econet InfraCo, the tower, power and property company listed in Victoria Falls, reported revenue of US$70.1 million and EBITDA of US$29.0 million for the six months to 31 August 2026, its first half-year results since listing.

Energy

> ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE FUEL MANAGEMENT ON TOWER SITES

- **Econet InfraCo - Unaudited Abridged Interim Financial Statements for the Half Year Ended 31 August 2026** — Econet Infrastructure Company Limited, 1 October 2026

  Summarised under Connectivity.

Cybersecurity

> CYBERSECURITY OF INDUSTRIAL CONTROL NETWORKS AT A PLATINUM MINE

- **Rockwell secures Mimosa Mine control networks in Zimbabwe** — Tech Africa, 2 September 2026

  OT segmentation retrofit at a platinum mine; no value, no timeline, no incident cited.

> INVESTIGATION INTO WHATSAPP BUSINESS ACCOUNT TAKEOVERS

- **Govt probes mass WhatsApp takeovers in Zimbabwe** — ITWeb Africa, 14 October 2026

> Zimbabwe's ICT minister Tatenda Mavetera said her ministry has opened a multi-agency investigation, including the police Cyber Crime Division, into a wave of WhatsApp Business account takeovers. It will examine whether personal or financial data was compromised and the role of SMS termination aggregators, and is engaging Meta and the affected mobile operator.

> CYBERSECURITY FRAMEWORK FOR CRITICAL INFRASTRUCTURE PROTECTION

- **POTRAZ moves to tighten cybersecurity for critical infrastructure** — The Herald (Zimbabwe), 15 October 2026

  Zimbabwe's telecoms regulator is developing a Cybersecurity Framework for Critical Infrastructure Protection, its draft regulation cited as a governance example at a regulators' follow-up meeting in Nairobi. The regulator also restated that data controllers must be licensed under the Cyber and Data Protection Act.

DPI

Data Exchange

> REGIONAL CUSTOMS-TO-CUSTOMS DATA EXCHANGE ROADMAP

- **Five Southern African countries move to link customs data as trade corridors face pressure to cut delays** — Southern African Times, 2 September 2026 ZAMBIA MALAWI MOZAMBIQUE SOUTH AFRICA SOUTHERN AFRICA

  Pretoria roadmap for customs-to-customs data exchange across five corridors, 24-26 August.

> MOBILE MONEY VALIDATION AGAINST THE CIVIL REGISTRY

- **RBZ shuts down ghost wallets** — Business Times, 10 September 2026

  Civil Registry national database linked to mobile-money subscriber records to close duplicate wallets.

- **RBZ closes loopholes on mobile money illicit financial flows, fraud** — The Herald, 14 September 2026

  RBZ completed Civil Registry integration with mobile money subscriber records for biometric verification.

Digital Payments and Fintech

> INTERMEDIATED MONEY TRANSFER TAX (IMTT)

- **Zimbabwe: Country Growth and Jobs Report (P512930)** — World Bank Group, 2 September 2026

  World Bank urges Zimbabwe to consider phasing out the 2% IMTT, ZiG first; mobile money used by 63%.

- **World Bank warns Zim** — Business Times (Zimbabwe), 17 September 2026

  Free lede only: the Bank says the transaction tax pushes activity back to cash.

> FREQUENT TRAVELLER EXPRESS PASS TOLL PRE-PAYMENT

- **Checking Your ZINARA Frequent Traveller Express Pass (FTEP) Balance** — TechnoMag, 3 September 2026

  FTEP balance by WhatsApp: text Zinara plus the vehicle registration number to +263 771 288 940.

> DIGITAL FOREIGN-EXCHANGE TRADING SYSTEM

- **Zimbabwe says single-currency switch hinges on market conditions** — NewZimbabwe (Bloomberg), 16 September 2026

  RBZ to launch a digital FX trading system in Q4 2026, World Bank peer-reviewed; import cover at 1.8 months.

INVOICEX INVOICE-DISCOUNTING MARKETPLACE

- **Zimbabwe Stock Exchange launches InvoiceX 48-hour invoice discounting market** — BCR Publishing, 24 September 2026

  The Zimbabwe Stock Exchange opened InvoiceX, a regulated invoice-discounting market run under the Zimbabwe Entrepreneurship Exchange, for invoices of US$1,000 to US$1.5 million. Once a buyer authenticates an invoice, licensed banks and microfinance lenders bid on the discount rate, with supplier payment targeted within 48 hours and platform fees of 0.65% of the transaction.

REAL-TIME PAYMENTS SYSTEM ON INDIA'S UPI TECHNOLOGY

- **Zimbabwe eyes India's UPI tech for national payments network; NPCI talks may wrap by October 31** — Moneycontrol, 6 October 2026

  Zimbabwe's central bank is negotiating with NPCI International to build a real-time payments system on India's UPI technology, linking banks, mobile-money operators and fintechs. The governor told Bloomberg an agreement is possible by 31 October 2026; cross-border payments and remittances are not part of the first deployment.

PAN-AFRICAN PAYMENT AND SETTLEMENT SYSTEM PARTICIPATION

- **CEO Africa Roundtable: Zimbabwe processes $5.8 million a month through PAPSS as local currency settlement takes hold** — The Herald, 8 October 2026

  Afreximbank said Zimbabwe is processing US$5.8 million a month through the pan-African payment and settlement system. Yuan clearing is being brought onto the platform through its link to China's interbank system.

Registries

STATUTORY INSTRUMENT 76 OF 2025 ON SECURITISED DEEDS

- **Unvalidated Title Deeds To Lose Formal Recognition in 11 Months** — Open Parly ZW, 11 September 2026

  DLAP to be sole title register after July 2027 deadline; US$215 all-in validation fee; unvalidated deeds keep title.

NATIONAL MSME DATABASE

- **Gvt Moves to Create National Database for Small Businesses** — 263Chat, 13 October 2026

  Zimbabwe's small-enterprise development corporation said a national database of micro, small and medium enterprises has reached minimum-viable-product stage, with an online registration portal in development. Talks are under way to link it to the revenue authority and the procurement regulator.

Sectoral management information systems

LABORATORY INFORMATION MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

- **GP4382002 ZWE Laboratory Information Management System (LIMS)** — UNGM, 14 September 2026

  UNGM notice GP4382002 seeks a supplier to implement a Laboratory Information Management System in Zimbabwe.

- **Govt takes diagnostics closer to rural communities** — Zimbabwe Situation (source: The Herald), 23 September 2026

  LIMS live at 117 main laboratories, 80% facility target by 2030, results by SMS; feeds the Impilo e-health platform.

INTEGRATED ELECTRONIC CASE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

- **Electronic Case Management System (IECMS) brings justice closer to Gweru residents** — The Chronicle (via Herald), 26 September 2026

  Phase 4.4 e-court rollout to Midlands and Mashonaland West magistrates from 1 Oct 2026; Harare, Bulawayo by year-end.

- **Paperless courts spread to Midlands, Mashonaland West** — The Herald (Zimbabwe), 6 October 2026

  Zimbabwe's Judicial Service Commission took its electronic case management system live in Midlands and Mashonaland West provinces on 1 October, after installing recording and transcription machines and issuing computers to court staff. Litigants and lawyers can file and follow cases online.

POLICE CRIME MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

- **ZRP pilots digital crime reporting system developed by Harare Institute of Technology at Warren Park Police Station** — The Herald, 8 October 2026

  Zimbabwe's home affairs minister told the National Assembly that a crime management system built by the Harare Institute of Technology is running as a proof of concept at Warren Park and a few other police stations. Reporting crime by mobile phone is to follow, and wider deployment depends on the test.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SMART POST OFFICES PROGRAMME

- **Mavetera sets 2030 deadline for Smart Post Offices** — Spiked Media, 19 September 2026

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **Zimbabwe sets out plan to modernise postal and courier services for digital economy** — TechReviewAfrica, 20 September 2026

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

ELECTRONIC TRAFFIC MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

- **Electronic traffic system being finalised** — Zimbabwe Situation, 13 October 2026

  Zimbabwe's police said logistics for an Electronic Traffic Management System were being finalised. The system is linked to the vehicle and civil registries to identify offenders and issue penalties electronically.

Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

DIGITAL HEALTH SITES IN POST OFFICES

- **ZimSmart converts ZimPost offices into digital health clinics** — The Herald, 9 October 2026

  28 nurse-staffed sites in post offices and containers; Starlink and NetOne links; 118,000 reached.

Technology

AI

OPERATOR INDIGENOUS-LANGUAGE CUSTOMER CHATBOTS

- **Econet Ai nears completion of Ndebele-speaking chatbot** — CITE Zimbabwe, 6 September 2026

  Ndebele bot phased in from September 2026; Shona-language Yamurai already resolves over 70% of enquiries.

SMART TRAFFIC MANAGEMENT SYSTEM (ZRP SMART POLICING PROGRAMME)

- **Govt pursues traffic violators as 4m offences caught on camera** — Zimbabwe Situation (source: Herald), 27 September 2026

  Over 4m violations on Harare's AI cameras by end-Sept 2026; fines now pursued, 20 cameras up, 300+ planned.

Innovation ecosystem

BEYOND-VISUAL-LINE-OF-SIGHT MEDICAL DRONE DELIVERIES

- **Zimbabwe clears drones to deliver vaccines, blood and medicines** — NewZimbabwe, 22 September 2026

  CAAZ BVLOS approval for Drone Solutions; vaccines, blood and samples in about 30 minutes after August 2026 trials.

Capacity

Training and skills

RURAL AI, DIGITAL AND INNOVATION HUB AT NYAMURORO VOCATIONAL TRAINING CENTRE

- **UNDP Partners Gvt To Launch First Rural AI, Digital and Innovation Hub at Nyamuroro VTC in Gokwe** — TechnoMag, 29 September 2026

  Solar-powered, Starlink-linked hub in Gokwe; 50 youths in free bootcamp, 3,000 learners and 300 teachers targeted.

Research institutions

NATIONAL DIGITAL TECHNOLOGIES POLICY RESEARCH PROGRAMME

- **Call for policy research proposals: National Digital Technologies Policy Research Programme (DTPRP)** — Postal and Telecommunications Regulatory Authority of Zimbabwe, Research Council of Zimbabwe and Scientific and Industrial Research and Development Centre, 7 September 2026

  Five priority areas, from AI governance to data sovereignty; proposals to POTRAZ by 3 October 2026.

- **POTRAZ National Digital Technologies Policy Research Programme 2026: Call for Policy Research Proposals** — ApplyNOW (POTRAZ, RCZ and SIRDC call), 9 September 2026

  Proposals close 3 October 2026; AI governance, data sovereignty and platform regulation among five priority areas.

Inclusion

Access to services

DIGITAL SKILLS TRAINING FOR PERSONS WITH DISABILITIES

- **Zimbabwe expands ICT skills support for teachers with visual impairments** — Digital Watch Observatory, 3 September 2026

  37 blind and low-vision teachers, assistants and aides from all 10 provinces at a POTRAZ workshop in Chiredzi.

INTERNET AND DATA TRAFFIC

- **Zimbabwe's internet traffic jumps 57%** — ITWeb Africa, 4 September 2026

> Zimbabwe's internet and data traffic rose 57.28% in the first quarter of 2026, the regulator reported, attributing it to faster LTE and 5G deployment, rising smartphone adoption and data-hungry applications. Operators added 13 5G base stations in the quarter to reach 379, covering 18.94% of the population, and deployed 161 further LTE sites; mobile internet and data was the largest revenue contributor at 46.34% of quarterly operator revenue.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

> BILATERAL HEALTH COOPERATION MEMORANDUM
>
> - **A data-sharing clause derailed US-Zimbabwe health talks. Now all funding ends this month** — The Independent (AP wire, by Farai Mutsaka), 25 September 2026
>
>   US Embassy: all US health funding ends September 2026; Harare refused an MoU tied to sensitive health data access.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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